Christian Vedel



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Languages: Fluent: Danish, English; Basic: Norwegian, Swedish

A note on my last name: I currently share my last name 'Sørensen' with 101,473 other Danes. For this reason, it is not of much use as an identifier in a population of only 5.8 mil. Instead, I use my middle name: 'Vedel', which I share with fewer people.

Research interests

What drives all of my research is a simple premise: much of what we know about the economic cosmos is limited by what we can measure. I build machine learning tools and large-scale historical datasets to recover economic measurements from the past, and combine them with causal inference methods to study how geography and institutions shape prosperity. The ultimate aim is to use the vastness of history to give policy makers better maps of what can be changed, what cannot, and where the limits of policy lie.

Keywords: Economic history, Economic Development, Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Economic Geography, Large-Scale Historical Data

Academic positions

2023–2027	Assistant Professor *Fixed-term, non-tenure-track appointment* *Department of Economics,* *Historical Economics and Development Group (HEDG)* *University of Southern Denmark*
2024–present	External Lecturer *Summer School in European Economic History* *Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen*
2018–2019	Student Research Assistant *Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark*
2017	Teaching Assistant *Department of Economics, University of Southern Denmark*

Education

2020–2023	PhD in Economics, University of Southern Denmark Title: *Natural Experiments in Geography and Institutions: Essays in the Economic History of Denmark* Main advisor: Paul Sharp Co-advisors: Christian Møller Dahl, Casper Worm Hansen

2022	Visiting Research Student, (Jan. 17 – May 31) Department of Economic History, London School of Economics Host: Prof. Max Schulze
2015–2021	BSc and MSc in Economics, University of Southern Denmark
2010–2013	International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP), Nyborg Gymnasium

Funding & Prizes

2027–2030	**Danish Independent Research Fund**, DFF-Forskningsprojekt2: 6 114 741 DKK *Denmark's Path to Economic Development: Structural Transformation, Free-Market Trade, and Migration from 1790 to Today* PI: Casper Worm Hansen. Named project participant
2023	**EHS Best New Researcher Prize** *Awarded at the Economic History Society's Annual Conference*
2022	**Augustinusfonden**: 15 000 DKK (€2 016) *Towards research stay at the London School of Economics*

Publications

Bentzen, J. S., Boberg-Fazlić, N., Sharp, P., Skovsgaard, C. V., & Vedel, C. (2026). Holy cows and spilled milk: The impact of religious missions on firm-level productivity. *Journal of Development Economics*, 179, 103651. doi.org/10.1016/j.jdeveco.2025.103651

McLaughlin, E., Sharp, P., Tsoukli, X., & Vedel, C. (2026). Ireland in a Danish mirror: A microlevel comparison of the productivity of Danish and Irish creameries before the First World War. *Business History*, 68(3), 596–612. doi.org/10.1080/00076791.2025.2486643

Henriques, S. T., Sharp, P., Tsoukli, X., & Vedel, C. (2024). Adaptability, diversification, and energy shocks: A firm level productivity analysis. *Energy Economics*, 139, 107887. DOI

Sharp, P., S. Henriques, E. McLaughlin, X. Tsoukli, and C. Vedel (2024). A Microlevel Analysis of Danish Dairy Cooperatives: Opportunities for Large Data in Business History. *Enterprise & Society*, 25(3), 669–697. doi.org/10.1017/eso.2023.5

McLaughlin, E., P. Sharp, X. Tsoukli, and C. Vedel (2024). A Firm Level Database of Irish Creameries, 1897–1921. *Irish Economic and Social History*, 51(1), 48–74. doi.org/10.1177/03324893231161927

Working papers

Vedel, C. (2024; latest version 2026). A Perfect Storm: First-Nature Geography and Economic Development. Job market paper; EHES Working Paper 262. Under review, *Journal of the European Economic Association*. arxiv.org/abs/2408.00885. *Winner of the Economic History Society's 2023 New Researcher Prize.* **Job Market Paper**

Johansen, T., Koschnick, J., & Vedel, C. (2026). How to deal with machine learning bias in economic history. arxiv.org/abs/2606.28063.

Dahl, C. M., Johansen, T., & Vedel, C. (2024; latest version 2026). Breaking the HISCO Barrier: Automatic Occupational Standardization with OccCANINE. EHES Working Paper 255. Revise and resubmit, *Explorations in Economic History*. arxiv.org/abs/2402.13604.

Görges, T., Rove, M. Ø., Sharp, P., & Vedel, C. (2025; latest version 2026). Tracks to Modernity: Railroads, Growth, and Social Movements in Denmark. Revise and resubmit, *European Review of Economic History*. arxiv.org/abs/2502.21141.

Aaskoven, L., & Vedel, C. (2026). Physical Memories of the Past and Support for the Far-Right: Evidence from Inter-War Denmark. EHES Working Paper 295. ehes.org/wp/EHES_295.pdf.

McLaughlin, E., Sharp, P., Skovsgaard, C. V., & Vedel, C. (2024). Milk Wars: Cooperation, Contestation, Conflict and the Irish War of Independence. EHES Working Paper 272. ehes.org/wp/EHES_272.pdf.

Bentzen, J. S., Boberg-Fazlić, N., Sharp, P., Skovsgaard, C. V., & Vedel, C. (2024). Assimilate for God: The Impact of Religious Divisions on Danish American Communities. EHES Working Paper 253. ehes.org/wp/EHES_253.pdf.

Other publications

Vedel, C. (2023). Natural Experiments in Geography and Institutions: Essays in the Economic History of Denmark. [Ph.D. thesis, SDU]. Syddansk Universitet. Det Samfundsvidenskabelige Fakultet. doi.org/10.21996/jt34-zc23

Vedel, C. (2025). Review of *Danish Capitalism in the 20th Century: A Business History of an Innovistic Mixed Economy*, by Stefan Kirkegaard Sløk-Madsen. *Scandinavian Economic History Review*, 73(2), 160–162.

Vedel, C. (2022). Trap Denmark: Tønder, Aabenraa, Sønderborg (vol 17). *Scandinavian Economic History Review*. doi.org/10.1080/03585522.2021.2013315

Vedel, C. (2022). A very natural experiment: using nature to measure how infrastructure produces growth. London School of Economics, Economic History Blog. blogs.lse.ac.uk/economichistory (2022)

Teaching experience

S: Spring semester; F: Fall semester

2026S	**Statistics** Course coordinator and lecturer. Introductory statistics for undergraduate Economics students Find open source teaching material here: github.com/christianvedels/Introductory_statistics
2024–2026	**The Economic History of Europe** *Summer school* University of Copenhagen

2024-2026 **Historical Perspectives on Current Economics Issues: Big Data and Applications**
HEDG PhD Summer School
Teaching a two lecture module on Machine Learning for Economic History together with Torben Johansen Slides:
github.com/TorbenSDJohansen/hedg-summer-school

2023F–2025F **News and Market Sentiment Analysis**
Lecturer. Course on natural language processing for students in the Data Science Masters programme. Find open source course material here:
github.com/christianvedels/News_and_Market_Sentiment_Analytics

2025S **Statistics**
Lecturer. Introductory statistics for undergraduate Business Administration and European Studies students

2023F–2024S **Microeconomics**
Lecturer. Introductory microeconomics for business students

2022F **Business History**
Lecturer with Elena Korchmina

2020–2022 **Tietgen talent track**
Talent track for high school students from Tietgen business high school. I coordinate the program and teach everything from basic economic theory to latest research and basic statistics

2020F **Introduction to Business and Economic History (undergraduate)**
Teaching assistant (partly online due to COVID).

2020–2021 **Regression Analysis (undergraduate)**
Guest lecture for one week both years. Taught introduction to the R statistical programming language.

2020S **Econometrics II (undergraduate)**
Teaching assistant (partly online due to COVID)

2017F **Macroeconomics (undergraduate)**
Teaching assistant

Supervision

PhD students

2024–2027 Co-supervisor of PhD student Maret Anne Grapengeter (University of Oslo)

Master thesis students (Economics)

2025 Lea Lundberg Yssing, Sharmin Ather Keya

Master thesis students (Mathematical Economics)

2026 Katrine Enghoff Olsen, Lajza Prekazi

Master thesis students (Data Science)

2026 Frederikke Buchsti Hermansen, Christoffer Johan Meilby Nobel, Rune Dissing Bjerring

2025 Lukas Rask Svendsen

Presentations

2026	Social Science History Association, SSHA (Atlanta); Danish Society for Economic and Social History (SDU); Workshop: Computational Economic History (CSH Vienna); Workshop: Big Data and Machine Learning in Economic History (Uppsala); Economic History Society Centenary Conference (London); CEPR Workshop (University of Copenhagen); Public Lecture for the Society of Transport Economics (Copenhagen)
2025	Social Science History Association (Chicago); Applied Economic Seminar Series (UCPH); LEAP Workshop on Economic History in the Age of AI (Stellenbosch); Swedish Economic History Meeting and Scandinavian Society for Economic and Social History Conference (Umeå); European Network for the Comparative History of Population Geography and Occupational Structure (Cracow); European Society of Historical Demography Conference (Bologna)
2024	2nd Norwegian Winter Games (Oslo); Workshop on Machine Learning at the Department of Economic History (Lund); 13th Annual Growth Workshop, HEDG (Odense); Economic History Society Annual Conference (Newcastle); 3rd Danish Historical Political Economy Workshop (Odense); CITP conference (Nottingham); Advanced Methods Workshop (Lyon); Annual Meeting of the Danish Econometrics Society (Sandbjerg)
2023	Seminar at the Department of Economic History (Lund); 12th Annual Growth Workshop, HEDG (Odense); Economic History Society annual conference (Warwick); PhD seminar at the Department of Economics (Odense); End of semester workshop at the Department of Economic (Copenhagen); 9th World Cliometrics Conference; 4th Annual Conference of the Scandinavian Society for Economic and Social History (Lund); ENCHOS Conference (Linz); 9th Annual Meeting of the Danish Society of Economic and Social History (Copenhagen)
2022	XIX World Economic History Congress (Paris); EHES conference 2022 (Gronningen); LSE Graduate Economic History Seminar (London); 11th Annual Growth Workshop, HEDG (Odense); 3rd Scandinavian Meeting for Economic and Social History (Odense); HEDG Miniworkshop for young scholars (Odense)
2021	Agricliometrics IV, UCIII Madrid; HEDG Miniworkshop for young scholars; DGPE Annual meeting; PhD seminar at the Department of Economics (SDU, Odense)
2020	DGPE Annual meeting; PhD seminar at the Department of Economics (SDU, Odense)

Academic service

Refereeing	*Review of Economics and Statistics*; *Scandinavian Economic History Review*; *Demographic Research*; *Digital Scholarship in the Humanities*; *Historical Methods*; *Program Committee of International Conference on Natural Language and Speech Processing (ICNLSP)*
Community	Editor, EHES Working Paper Series, European Historical Economics Society Board member, Danish Society for Economic and Social History
Organisation	Co-organiser, Annual Workshop on Growth, History and Development (HEDG) (many times) Co-organiser of Policy Event (2025, 2026)

Non-academic employment

2019–2020	**Number Crunch**, Odense My own small data consulting firm
2018–2019	**Municipality of Copenhagen**, Copenhagen Student assistant in the department of data and analysis of the health and care administration